

PHASE 2

FLOW ASSIGNMENT

Milestone: Flow assignment

Activity 1: Flow Assignment to the Standard Laptop Service Catalog item.
Stated activity duration: 11 hours 40 minutes

Project: Streamlining IT Procurement — Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Platform: ServiceNow (Flow Designer, Service Catalog)

1. Phase Overview

Creating a flow in isolation has no effect on the Service Catalog until it is explicitly attached to the relevant catalog item. This phase connects the "Standard laptop task" flow (built in Phase 1) to the **Standard Laptop** catalog item's Process Engine, so that the flow executes automatically whenever a Standard Laptop request moves through the catalog.

2. Objective

Associate the flow created in Phase 1 with the Standard Laptop Service Catalog item so that the catalog item's fulfillment process is driven by that flow rather than by any other workflow or automation.

3. Purpose of Flow Assignment

A ServiceNow Catalog Item's Process Engine determines which automation mechanism (Flow, Workflow, or Execution Plan) governs its fulfillment. Only one engine may be active per catalog item. Assigning the "Standard laptop task" flow here ensures that any pre-existing or default automation on the Standard Laptop item is replaced with the flow built specifically for this project, so that the correct Catalog Task is generated every time this item is ordered.

4. ServiceNow Components Involved

- Maintain Items module (catalog item administration)
- Standard Laptop — Catalog Item record
- Process Engine tab (Flow / Workflow / Execution Plan selector)
- "Standard laptop task" flow (created in Phase 1)

5. Detailed Configuration Procedure

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click **All** and search for **Maintain Items**.
3. Open the **Maintain Items** module.
4. In the **Name** field, search for **Standard Laptop**.
5. Select the **Standard Laptop** catalog item record.
6. Open the **Process Engine** section/tab on the record.
7. Remove any pre-existing automation reference(s) in the Workflow / Execution Plan fields, as specified in the assignment guide, so that only one engine is active.
8. In the **Flow** field, add/select the flow created in Phase 1: **"Standard laptop task"**.
9. Open the record menu and **save** the record.

6. Configuration Table

Field / Setting	Value
Catalog Item	Standard Laptop
Category	Hardware
Application	Global
Active	True
Process Engine — Flow	Standard laptop task
Process Engine — Workflow	(cleared / not set)
Process Engine — Execution Plan	(cleared / not set)

7. Implementation Evidence

The following screenshot was captured from the author's own ServiceNow instance during implementation of this phase.

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow interface for configuring a catalog item. The top navigation bar includes 'All', 'Favorites', 'History', 'Admin', and a search bar. The breadcrumb trail indicates the current location: 'Catalog Item - Standard Laptop'. The main form is divided into two sections. The top section contains fields for 'Name' (Standard Laptop), 'Application' (Global), 'Active' (checked), 'Fulfillment automation level' (Unspecified), 'Category' (Hardware), 'State' (None), 'Checked out' (None), and 'Owner'. The bottom section, titled 'Process Engine', contains a message: 'Select the appropriate process engine for the catalog item. Only one engine can be selected.' Below this message are three fields: 'Flow' (Standard laptop task), 'Workflow' (empty), and 'Execution Plan' (empty). The 'Flow' field is highlighted with a green border.

Figure 2.1 — Author's implementation: Standard Laptop catalog item, Process Engine tab, showing the Flow field set to "Standard laptop task" with no competing Workflow or Execution Plan configured.

8. Acceptance / Configuration Checklist

- [] Standard Laptop catalog item located via Maintain Items.
- [] Process Engine tab opened on the record.
- [] Any pre-existing Workflow / Execution Plan automation removed.
- [] Flow field set to "Standard laptop task".
- [] Record saved successfully with the new Process Engine configuration retained.

9. Expected Outcome

With the flow assigned as the sole Process Engine for the Standard Laptop item, every future order of this catalog item is expected to trigger the "Standard laptop task" flow automatically, resulting in a Catalog Task being generated with the field values configured in Phase 1 (Short Description, Description, Assignment group, and Approval), with no other automation path competing for control of the request.

10. Conclusion

Phase 2 links the automation built in Phase 1 to the actual point of consumption — the Standard Laptop catalog item. By setting the Process Engine's Flow field and clearing any competing automation, the project ensures a single, predictable path from catalog request to Catalog Task generation. This assignment is a prerequisite for the end-to-end validation carried out in Phase 3.